

FROM HR HEAD TO BUSINESS ARCHITECT



Strategic Impact Over Metrics: CHROs are moving beyond KPIs and engagement scores to shape business outcomes



Skills-First Mindset: Success now requires focusing on capabilities, not just job roles, especially in an AI-driven world



Boardroom Influence: Modern CHROs have a stronger voice, advising on workforce readiness, agility, and talent gaps



Co-Architecting Strategy: CHROs collaborate with leadership to anticipate risks, build resilience, and drive cultural transformation



AI Integration: Redesigning work by combining human judgment, creativity, and AI fluency is now central to HR strategy



Continuous Reinvention: The evolving workforce demands flexible, dynamic talent strategies and lifelong learning



Trust and Culture: During uncertainty, CHROs uphold trust, transparency, and alignment, ensuring people remain informed and engaged

A STRONGER VOICE

Not long ago, HR discussions at the board level were largely limited to defined areas like compensation or succession, that was the lane. “Today, that has shifted quite a bit,” says Suri.

It’s no longer enough to rely on annual workforce plans or lagging indicators. According to Suri, boards want to know what’s happening now, where critical skills are being lost, where strengths are building, and whether the organisation is moving fast enough compared to the market.

Ghose reinforces the shift in strategic positioning: “CHROs absolutely have a seat at the table. But even succession planning today is no longer traditional. High turnover and changing expectations mean talent strategies have to be far more dynamic.”

FROM CO-PILOT TO CO-ARCHITECT

Chandrasekhar Sripada, Clinical Professor (OB), Indian School of Business believes the CHRO’s evolution into a co-architect of business strategy is already underway in progressive organisations.

“The role of the CHRO has already been that of a co-pilot, with many companies treating the CHRO as a co-owner of business strategy and execution,” he says, while noting that many organisations continue to view HR as an administrative function.

He adds that the shift to business resilience leadership will be defined by a new set of capabilities. “A deeper understanding of the business, enterprise-wide thinking, and the ability to sense changes in the external environment in real time are among the most critical competencies for CHROs today,” he explains.

REWIRING WORK

AI and automation are no longer future considerations but realities reshaping how work gets done. The shift, Suri, argues, begins with moving away from jobs to a skills-first mindset.

He also highlights the emergence of AI fluency as a new baseline. “It’s about learning to work with AI, knowing when to trust it, when to question it, and how to use it effectively,” he says.

Adding to this, Ghose points out the deeper shift in value creation: “Organisations are not managing headcount or workforce in the traditional sense they are managing intellectual capital. What matters is the ability to generate ideas, scale them, and stay ahead of the curve.”

He also highlights the talent challenge: “Even to leverage AI, you need a different calibre of people. Legacy workforces alone cannot drive that shift. CHROs must